PRE-PURCHASE INSPECTION CHECKLIST

Jeep Gladiator JT

2020–present · JT · Rubicon · Mojave

BOXYTRUCKS

CHECK BEFORE YOU BUY

- [ ] **Run the VIN for recalls first**
  Gladiators have had recalls for rear driveshafts (19V-636), manual clutches (20V-124, 21V-028, 23V-116 and 24V-572), EcoDiesel fuel pumps (22V-767, 23V-263), instrument clusters (24V-652) and, in June 2026, power-steering pump wiring that can start a fire with the truck parked (26V-363). Confirm each one is done.
- [ ] **Manual trucks: ask about the clutch**
  The clutch pressure plate can overheat and fracture. FCA first issued software, then replaced clutch assemblies under 23V-116, and some 2021 trucks needed a second software fix under 24V-572. Ask for dealer paperwork, not a shrug.
- [ ] **Drive it at 50–65 mph over a bump**
  Gladiators can shimmy or wobble after a highway expansion joint, as JLs can. Owners on JeepGladiatorForum report dealers replacing the steering damper or the steering box. Any wobble means the front end needs inspecting before you hand over money.
- [ ] **Diesel? Check the fuel pump history**
  EcoDiesels were recalled twice for high-pressure fuel pumps that can fail and stall the engine. Look for the recall paperwork, ask about fuel-filter changes and look at the oil level. Diesel trucks are also about 300 lb heavier, so payload is lower.
- [ ] **Look under the bed and behind the bumpers**
  Check the frame, bed mounts and spare-tire carrier for damage from off-road use. Check the rock rails and skids for dents that hint at hard use, and the hitch area for signs of heavy towing.
- [ ] **Know which axle and gearing you're buying**
  Sport and Overland trucks came with 3.73 gears and a narrower 62.9 in track. The Max Tow package, Rubicon and Mojave have 4.10 gears and wider track. Rubicons add front and rear lockers and the 4:1 transfer case. Check the window sticker or build sheet.
- [ ] **Lifted trucks: inspect the steering and track-bar mounts**
  Big tires and lifts load the steering box, track bars and their mounts. Look for elongated holes, fresh paint on welds, and torque marks that have moved. Ask what was done to correct the track-bar geometry.
- [ ] **Hardtop and doors**
  Make sure the Freedom panels, hardtop seals and removable doors come with the truck and fit without leaking. Water stains on the carpet usually mean worn seals or poorly fitted panels.

RECALLS TO ASK ABOUT

- [ ] **Rear driveshaft monoblock assembled without grease**
  2020 · NHTSA 19V-636

IS IT THE REAL THING?

- ☐ **Manual clutch pressure plate**
  2020 · NHTSA 20V-124
- ☐ **Manual clutch pressure plate (software)**
  2020–2021 · NHTSA 21V-028
- ☐ **Manual clutch assembly replacement**
  2020–2023 · NHTSA 23V-116
- ☐ **PCM software after clutch remedy**
  2021 · NHTSA 24V-572
- ☐ **Front seat belt retractor**
  2020 · NHTSA 20V-580
- ☐ **Rear camera image**
  2020–2021 · NHTSA 20V-191 / 22V-638
- ☐ **Automatic transmission park pawl**
  2022 · NHTSA 22V-639
- ☐ **Seat belt pretensioner gas generator**
  2022 · NHTSA 22V-766
- ☐ **3.0 EcoDiesel high-pressure fuel pump**
  2021–2022 · NHTSA 22V-767

- ☐ **Rubicon**
  Rock-Trac transfer case with 4:1 low range, front and rear Tru-Lok lockers, 4.10 gears, electronic sway-bar disconnect, LT285/70R17 tires and wide-track axles (64.4 in). Look for the locker and sway-bar switches on the dash.
- ☐ **Mojave**
  FOX 2.5 in internal-bypass shocks with external reservoirs, FOX hydraulic front jounce bumpers, 'Desert Rated' fender badges, orange tow hooks, 65.0 in track, rear locker that works at speed in 4-High. Command-Trac 2.72:1 low range, not Rock-Trac.
- ☐ **Max Tow (Sport, Sport S)**
  4.10 gears, wider 64.4 in track and the 7,650 lb rating (8-speed only, 2020 spec). Without it, Sports have 3.73 gears and a 62.9 in track.
- ☐ **EcoDiesel**
  2021–2023 only, automatic only and never on a Mojave. The 2023 Rubicon FarOut has a 'Diesel 3.0L' hood graphic; 1,000 were built.
- ☐ **Pre- or post-2024**
  2024-on trucks have a seven-slot grille with narrower slots, no mast antenna (it's in the windshield), the 12.3 in Uconnect 5 screen and standard curtain airbags.
- ☐ **Rubicon Launch Edition**
  2020 only, 4,190 built (a nod to Toledo's 419 area code), with special badges and wheels and a leather-wrapped dash with red stitching.

NOTES

From the full guide at https://boxytrucks.com/models/jeep/gladiator-jt/, with sources. Recalls follow the VIN: check at nhtsa.gov/recalls. General information only, not a professional inspection; see boxytrucks.com/about/disclaimer/. © BoxyTrucks